

financial stability. My hope is that the information and lessons in this book will help prevent you from being one of the statistics above.

Each chapter describes its topic in easy-to-understand language, provides practical examples, offers a personal experience I have had with the topic, and gives you a chance to build your skills with your newfound knowledge. Ideally, you would read this book from cover to cover and the information would stick with you forever, just like *Jane Eyre* and *The Scarlet Letter*. Tragically, this is unlikely. Instead, this book can be consulted at any point in your journey through life. If you need help creating an effective budget, pick up this book; if you do not know the difference between a Roth and a traditional 401(k), pick up this book; if you do not know what an insurance deductible is, pick up this book. Understanding and taking control of your financial future begins now.